Citation verification procedure

Why this exists. AI can "generate falsified research references, that is, plausible citations with reasonable title, author, and journal combinations for papers that do not exist" (McGill GPS, 2024; V§5). ICMJE requires humans to "ensure there is appropriate attribution of all quoted material, including full citations" (V§4). **Claude's memory is not a source.**

The procedure (every citation, every time)

1. **Retrieve the primary source itself.** That means the actual paper, policy or documentation page, not a summary, secondary blog or search-result snippet.
   - *Doesn't count as verification:* search-engine summaries; web-fetch tools that answer questions about a page through an AI model (they paraphrase and truncate); anything recalled from memory.
   - *Does count:* the downloaded PDF or HTML whose text is read directly; a publisher page; a DOI that resolves.
2. **Confirm the identity.** Authors, year, title and venue match. The DOI resolves (open `https://doi.org/<doi>`).
3. **For a quote**, copy the text **character-for-character** from the retrieved document. Record the section or page. Keep quotes brief (a sentence or two); longer passages get paraphrased and marked PARAPHRASE.
4. **For a claim about a number or method** (for example "Aubry et al. set σ = 7× the energy increment"), locate the exact passage or equation that supports it. If the claim can't be located, it stays UNVERIFIED.
5. **Archive** a copy (or the relevant excerpt) in the project's `sources/` folder. Record the URL and the retrieval date.
6. **Label** the citation wherever it is used:

Label	Meaning	May appear in a publication?
`VERIFIED`	Exact text or claim confirmed against the archived primary source	Yes
`PARAPHRASE`	Checked against the source; reworded	Yes
`UNVERIFIED`	Not yet checked against the source	**No.** Verify it or remove it
`SECONDARY`	Known only through another work that cites it	Only as "as cited in …"

7. **Human spot-check.** Before submission, Reza (or a delegate) re-checks a random ~20% of VERIFIED items against the archived copies. Record who checked, and when.

Rules

- **No citation to justify a choice after the fact while passing it off as the original reason.** If a parameter was a library default or a judgement call, the registry says so. A paper found later is recorded as "later found consistent with".
- **Code comments follow the same rules as papers.** A reference in a code comment carries a status label.
- **Never cite AI output as a primary source** (ICMJE, V§4).

Citation record format (for code comments and the registry)

```
[AUTHOR YEAR] Title. Venue. DOI/URL.  Status: VERIFIED (retrieved 2026-09-18; §4.2, p.7)
  Quote: "…exact words…"
  Archived: research_integrity/sources/<file>
```